

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 694

By White

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Dow Smith on
receiving the 2025 Business at Its Best Award.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable person is Dow Smith, who was recently presented with the 2025 Business at Its Best Award; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Smith founded Dow Smith Company more than thirty years ago, beginning his first project in January 1992 with the renovation of Building 661 at the Smyrna Airport while operating out of a red Chevy S-10 pickup truck that also served as his office and sole piece of equipment; and

WHEREAS, following the successful completion of that project, Dow Smith upgraded his office by moving into the very building he had renovated, thereby launching a journey of steady growth and reinvention; over the decades, the company has operated from a series of locations in Smyrna, including Building 660, 301 Jefferson Pike, 51 North Lowry, and its current headquarters at 205 Sam Hager Street; and

WHEREAS, under Mr. Smith's leadership, Dow Smith Company evolved from a low-bid general contractor into a distinctive design-build firm known for its innovative solutions and client-centered service; he continues to guide the company today in his role as visionary; and

WHEREAS, Dow Smith has intentionally embraced a Marketplace Ministry since 2004, integrating his Christian faith into his business life and leadership; he draws inspiration and grounding from prayer, including the "Welcoming Prayer" by Thomas Keating, the "Serenity Prayer," and the "Lord's Prayer"; and

WHEREAS, he is especially moved by the words of Bob Dylan, "If you're not busy being born, you're busy dying," a sentiment he sees echoed in Scripture and in the teachings of Jesus, and one he strives to embody in both life and work; and

WHEREAS, at the heart of Mr. Smith's success is his devotion to family; he feels at his best when with his beloved wife, Cindy, and finds his greatest joy when they are together with their sons, Harris and Mitchell; and

WHEREAS, the Business at Its Best Award honors not only entrepreneurial achievement, but also service, leadership, and values in action, all of which Mr. Smith has demonstrated with integrity and purpose; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Dow Smith for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Dow Smith on receiving the 2025 Business at Its Best Award and extend to him our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.